

Night flyers



As the sun sets, most birds settle down for a good night's sleep. Owls and nightjars, however, are preparing for a night of hunting.



Nightjars

Nightjars rest on the ground during the day. At night they hunt, plucking insects out of the air as they fly.

Barn owl

Hooked beaks help to tear up food.

Owls

All owls, such as this barn owl, hunt in darkness and must rely on their amazing eyesight and hearing to help them.

Owls use their sharp talons to catch and grip animals that they eat.

Owl types

Owls come in lots of sizes and colours and can be found around the world.



Great horned owl: this regal-looking owl has ear tufts or "horns".



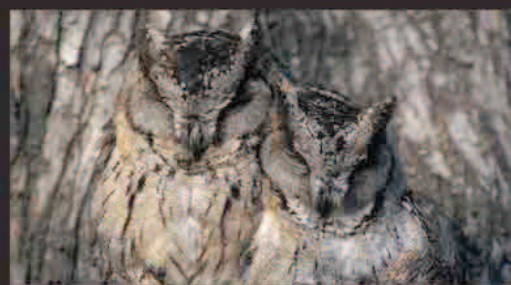
Spectacled owl: this owl lives in the South American rainforest.



Snowy owl: this owl has extra feathers on its feet, to keep it warm, like slippers.



Burrowing owl: this owl makes its nest underground.



Hidden from sight

During the day owls sleep, often in branches of trees. Their feathers camouflage them so well, as on these scops owls, that people very rarely notice them.

Many owls have velvety fringes around their flight feathers that make their wings very quiet as they fly through the air.

Owl eggs are almost completely round.